Key Messages

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- As a result of the prolonged seasonal dry spell, poor households in the Dry Corridor of Central America continue the see a deterioration of their livelihoods and are depending on the market to purchase of basic grains. In drought affected areas of Haiti, very poor households engage in subsistence activities such as petty trading and sale of charcoal.
- The persistence of El Niño conditions could cause an irregular start of the first rainy season in 2019 causing delays for the beginning of the *Primera* cropping cycle. Additionally, El Niño conditions may impact *Apante*'s agricultural cycle in production areas of Nicaragua and Honduras.
- In Central America, maize and bean market supplies are near average, due to an average *Postrera* harvest. Maize prices decreased but remain above average, meanwhile bean prices are expected to remain average to below average, except in Nicaragua where prices keep increasing. In Haiti, maize prices increased due to limited supply from drought affected areas. Local beans and imported rice prices remain above five-year average.
- Most households through the region are facing Stressed (IPC Phase 2) food security outcomes. A limited population in drought affected areas in Haiti, Central American Dry Corridor and areas in Guatemala with limited coffee labor income are seeing their livelihoods disrupted and are in Crisis (IPC Phase 3). The number of households in this situation will increase as the lean season advances.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more here.